

TMS, DMS and CMS Usage Guide for Falcon BMS 4.38.1

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Chapter 1

CMS – Countermeasures Management Switch

1.1 Concept

The Countermeasures Management Switch (CMS) is a four-direction hat switch mounted on the control stick. It provides single-point control of the aircraft's defensive systems: the ALE-47 CMDS (Countermeasures Dispenser Set — the automatic chaff and flare dispensing system) and ECM (Electronic Countermeasures) systems, either external pods or internal avionics, depending on block configuration.

CMS actuation procedures are detailed in [Section 1.2](#). F-16 blocks and variant differences are covered in [Section ??](#).

For in-depth coverage of CMDS and ECM operation, see *TO 1F-16CMAM-34-1-1*, Dash-34, sections 2.7.1 and 2.7.2, respectively. Diagrams of the flight stick and throttle controls are provided in Dash-34 § 2.1.5. [Figure 1.1](#) shows the CMS location on the F-16 control stick.



Figure 1.1: F-16 Throttle and Flight Stick. Image by Falconpedia (falcon4.wikidot.com), via Wikimedia Commons (https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:F-16_Side_Stick_Controller.jpg), licensed under the Creative Commons Attribution-Share Alike 3.0 Unported (CC BY-SA 3.0) license.

1.2 CMS Actuation

The tables in this section cover CMS usage by system: CMDS (Manual, Automatic, and Semi-Automatic modes) and ECM integration with both external pods (ALQ-131/ALQ-184) and internal avionics (IDIAS).

CMS actuation is independent of the Master Mode currently selected.

Each table entry specifies:

- **Mode:** The operational context (Master Mode).
- **Direction:** CMS hat direction (Up, Down, Left, Right).
- **Action:** Press type (Short, Long, Long Hold).
- **Function:** What the CMS command activates or controls.
- **Effect / Nuance:** Resulting system behavior, including tactics and constraints.
- **Dash34:** Reference section in the Dash-34 manual.
- **Training:** Recommended BMS training mission(s) (see BMS Training Manual 4.38.1 for descriptions).

1.2.1 CMDS

The ALE-47 CMDS provides three operational modes: Manual (MAN), Automatic (AUTO), and Semi-Automatic (SEMI), each described below.

The CMS is the control interface for program execution and consent authority in all three modes.

1.2.1.1 Manual Mode

In Manual (MAN) mode, the pilot executes countermeasure programs directly via CMS. Each CMS direction (**CMS Up** or **CMS Left**) executes a specific program.

Table 1.1: CMS Actuation with CMDS Manual Mode

Mode	Dir.	Act.	Function	Effect / Nuance	Dash34	Train.
CMDS MAN	Up	Short	Execute Program 1–4	Runs the program selected via the CMDS panel PRGM knob once per press. No threat sensing; no automatic triggering. Overrides any AUTO dispensing, if running.	2.7.2.2	18, 28
CMDS MAN	Left	Short	Execute Program 6	Flare-only program, activated regardless of PRGM knob position. Independent of threat sensing.	2.7.2.2	19

1.2.1.2 Automatic Mode

In Automatic (AUTO) mode, the ALE-47 CMDS dispenses the selected program (1–4) continuously in response to threats detected by the Radar Warning Receiver (RWR).

Pilot consent is given once by pressing **CMS Down**; dispensing continues until **CMS Right** is pressed or expendables are exhausted.

Table 1.2: CMS Actuation with CMDS Automatic Mode

Mode	Dir.	Act.	Function	Effect / Nuance	Dash34	Train.
CMDS AUTO	Up	Short	Execute Program 1–4	Runs the program selected via the CMDS panel PRGM knob once, interrupting any ongoing AUTO dispensing. After execution, AUTO resumes if the threat persists.	2.7.2.2	18, 28
CMDS AUTO	Left	Short	Execute Program 6	Manual flare-only program, overrides AUTO. After execution, AUTO resumes.	2.7.2.2	19
CMDS AUTO	Down	Short	Give Consent; Enable AUTO Dispensing	Grants consent for AUTO dispensing. RWR-detected threats trigger automatic execution of the program selected via the CMDS panel PRGM knob. Dispensing continues until the threat clears or CMS Right is pressed. Consent state persists if the pilot switches to MAN mode; returning to AUTO resumes auto-dispensing if a threat is detected.	2.7.2.1	18, 28
CMDS AUTO	Right	Short	Cancel Consent; Disable AUTO	Removes CMDS consent and places the ALE-47 in Standby. Automatic dispensing halts immediately. CMS Down must be re-issued to resume AUTO operation.	2.7.2.1	18, 28

1.2.1.3 Semi-Automatic Mode

In Semi-Automatic (SEMI) mode, the ALE-47 CMDS dispenses one program per RWR-detected threat, with pilot consent required for each event.

When a threat is detected, the CMDS control unit displays DISPENSE RDY and the system sounds a COUNTER voice message.

Table 1.3: CMS Actuation with CMDS Semi-Automatic Mode

Mode	Dir.	Act.	Function	Effect / Nuance	Dash34	Train.
CMDS SEMI	Up	Short	Execute Program 1–4	Runs the program selected via the CMDS panel PRGM knob once, independent of RWR threat state. After execution, CMDS resumes SEMI monitoring.	2.7.2.2	18, 28
CMDS SEMI	Left	Short	Execute Program 6	Manual flare-only program, independent of SEMI threat detection. After execution, CMDS resumes SEMI monitoring.	2.7.2.2	19
CMDS SEMI	Down	Short	Give Consent; Dispense One Program	Executes one instance of the selected program in response to a COUNTER prompt. If the threat persists or a new threat appears, CMDS issues COUNTER again. Consent state is tracked; switching to AUTO while consent is active resumes auto-dispensing immediately on the next threat.	2.7.2.1	18, 28

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Mode	Dir.	Act.	Function	Effect / Nuance	Dash34	Train.
CMD5 SEMI	Right	Short	Cancel Consent; Return to Standby	Removes SEMI consent. CMD5 halts monitoring and returns to Standby. COUNTER messages cease.	2.7.2.1	18, 28